regular contact with Lashkar according to one security official familiar with the case.[215]

The genesis of Brigitte's involvement in the plot can be traced to the time he spent training with Lashkar from late 2001 through early 2002. Sajid Mir, the Lashkar member responsible for managing its overseas operatives, was one of the men who debriefed Brigitte after his arrival and became his handler.[216] Brigitte told Bruguière during an interrogation that in 2002 Sajid directed him to leave Pakistan and return to Paris, where he was to act as a point of contact for any Lashkar operative transiting through France. Mir gave Brigitte his contact details, telling him to check in often. Brigitte kept in touch as directed, making at least forty phone calls to Sajid from Paris, not including calls possibly made from phone booths or emails sent from internet cafes.[217] During one of those communications, Sajid ordered Brigitte to travel to Australia and arranged financing for his trip. Brigitte detailed the process through which this was accomplished. He told French authorities that Sajid directed a Britain-based operative to instruct contacts in Paris to retrieve the money designated for financing the operation via the hawala system described in Chapter 4. According to Bruguière, the Lashkar operative in Britain was responsible for overseeing the recruitment of foreigners in Europe.[218] The latter arranged for two Paris-based colleagues to collect 3,500 Euros and provide the cash to Brigitte for his mission in Australia.[219] French police crosschecked this information, which Brigitte provided, with mobile phone and email traffic. Investigators confirmed there were a flurry of phone calls prior to Brigitte's departure for Australia between him, Sajid and Ashraf.[220]

Sajid also arranged for Lodhi to meet him upon arrival in Australia, providing the latter's phone number to Brigitte as well as giving his description to Lodhi.[221] An Australian court found that 'Sajid was endeavoring to co-ordinate a liaison between the offender [Lodhi] and Willie Brigitte in Sydney so that, in general terms, the prospect of terrorist actions in Australia could be explored.'[222] When Brigitte arrived at the airport in May 2003 Lodhi was there to greet him, as well as to help him obtain a flat and a phone purchased under a false identity.[223] Lodhi remained a persistent presence, but Brigitte's circle quickly grew beyond only him. In addition to building relationships with several other men suspected of involvement in jihadi activities by the ASIO, Brigitte soon